

The Human-AI Partnership Framework

Where human judgment belongs

Change-to-Deploy

PCF 8.6 — Plan, control & release changes — Value Stream Profile

This value stream comprises one APQC PCF process group: 8.6 Deploy Services/Solutions — spanning 5 Level 3 processes and 36 Level 4 activities.

At the activity level, this value stream's work breaks down as 17 Transaction activities (rules-based processing suited to automation), 11 Knowledge activities (judgment, synthesis, and interpretation-driven work), 6 Document activities (content generation), and 2 Decision activities (judgment-and-authority gates that stay human by design). No Exception-pattern activity exists within this value stream.

At M3 (HITL Design Intent), the value stream's aggregate human-involvement ratio is 48%, down from a 72% undesigned baseline — the steepest AI convergence opportunity of any PCF 8.0 value stream at 24 points.

L3 PROCESSES	L4 ACTIVITIES	M1 BASELINE H%	M3 DESIGN INTENT H%	Δ M1 → M3
5	36	72%	48%	-24%

KPIs

Business Impact Metric & Formula (where confirmed)	Source
Change Failure Rate <i>Deployments causing a service degradation or requiring remediation ÷ total deployments</i>	DORA
Mean Time to Recovery (MTTR) <i>Average time to restore service following a failed change or deployment</i>	DORA
Change Success Rate <i>Changes implemented successfully without rollback or incident on first attempt ÷ total changes</i>	ITIL

Design Narrative

Change-to-Deploy is IT Service Manager's second-largest lane in the domain: Accountable for 3 of 5 L3s — deployment strategy (8.6.1), implementation planning (8.6.2), and change deployment control itself (8.6.3) — textbook ITIL Change Management, the role's core mandate. DevOps Engineer holds Accountable for solution implementation (8.6.4), a pure-execution L3 that shifts from governance to hands-on deployment, and IT Support Specialist closes the stream with rollout (8.6.5) — training, communications, and end-user-facing rollout support rather than technical deployment. This value stream carries both PCF 8.0's steepest AI-absorption gap (24 points, the domain's largest) and its highest concentration of Transaction-pattern work (17 of 36 activities), reflecting how much of change/release management is procedural once the deployment decision itself is made. Its steepest single-activity gap sits in 8.6.1.3 (Define and create deployment procedure workflow, Document-pattern, -32 points).

AI Capability Map

Pattern-type distribution across this value stream's activity units. H% figures are the pattern type's standard value at each maturity level, applied consistently across all PCF domains.

Decision <i>Judgment & Authority — gates that stay human by design</i> 2 L4 activities M1 92% → M3 80%	Knowledge <i>Synthesis & Interpretation — judgment-driven work</i> 11 L4 activities M1 85% → M3 65%	Document <i>Content Generation — drafting and communication</i> 6 L4 activities M1 72% → M3 40%	Transaction <i>Rules-Based Processing — suited to automation</i> 17 L4 activities M1 60% → M3 35%	Exception <i>Non-Standard Resolution — human-resolved by nature</i> 0 L4 activities <i>No activities of this pattern in this value stream</i>
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Process Accountability

Process Accountability	Tier	L3 Processes	L4 Activities
IT Service Manager	Managerial	8.6.1, 8.6.2, 8.6.3	20
DevOps Engineer	Operational	8.6.4	9

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Process Accountability	Tier	L3 Processes	L4 Activities
IT Support Specialist	Operational	8.6.5	7

Handoff Points

The stream opens with IT Service Manager on deployment strategy, implementation planning, and deployment control (8.6.1–8.6.3) — the ITIL Change Management governance layer.

It then hands to DevOps Engineer for pure execution — implementing the technology solution itself (8.6.4) — before closing with IT Support Specialist on rollout (8.6.5): training, communications, and end-user-facing support distinct from the technical deployment.

Governed Decision Points

Every Decision/Exception-pattern activity in the value stream, including those embedded inside Mixed-labeled steps.

PCF	Decision	Authority	Impact	Escalates To	Trigger
8.6.1.5	Assign deployment approval responsibilities	IT Service Manager	Governance — establishes who can authorize production changes	IT Director (Managerial)	Approval authority must span multiple teams or a newly introduced deployment pathway
8.6.3.6	Approve change/release deployment	IT Service Manager	Operational — authorizes production change with direct service-continuity risk	IT Director (Managerial)	Change carries high-risk classification, touches a business-critical system, or falls outside the standard change window

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